

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
Lusaka, Zambia**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Lusaka, Zambia
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Knowledge Management and Communication

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Mr. Takawira Musavengana
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Senior Elections Advisor

3. Background information

UNDP works in more than 170 countries and territories, including Zambia, helping to achieve the eradication of poverty and the reduction of inequalities and exclusion. UNDP helps countries develop policies, leadership skills, partnering abilities, institutional capabilities and build resilience in order to sustain development results.

UNDP Zambia's Deepening Democracy Project (2025 - 2027) aims to consolidate democracy in Zambia through strengthening democratic institutions and processes towards the August 2026 general elections. Working with and through key national institutions, including the Electoral Commission of Zambia, relevant Government institutions, and non-state actors, the project builds upon previous investments through the 2016 Electoral Cycle Support Project and the Democracy Strengthening in Zambia Project (2020 - 2025). The overarching goal of the project is to entrench democratic governance, facilitate

structural transformations, and strengthen institutions to enhance transparency, accountability, and inclusive and informed civic engagement. In this regard, in line with the strategic direction outlined in the Country Programme Document (2023–2027), UNDP seeks to provide timely and effective technical assistance to enhance the inclusive participation of women, youth, people in lawful custody, persons with disabilities, and other marginalized groups in elections and related processes and institutions.

A Senior Advisor/Project Manager leads a project management team which is responsible for the planning and execution of activities, coordinating with stakeholders, managing resources, monitoring progress and accounting to the project Technical Committee and Steering Committee.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

The Knowledge Management and Communications Fellow will provide technical support to the Deepening Democracy Project (DDP) for effective knowledge management, innovative communication strategies, and stakeholder engagement. The Fellow will perform the following duties:

Knowledge Management and Coordination

- Contribute to the operationalization of a multi-channel dissemination strategy using digital media and emerging technologies, including Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools, to reach stakeholders at national and international levels.
- Support knowledge-sharing events and platforms to disseminate key project findings, enhancing visibility and impact.
- Maintain an up-to-date database of lessons learned, best practices, and project outputs, ensuring integration into planning and implementation processes.

Content Development and Documentation

- Contribute to the development and update knowledge products such as policy briefs, reports, fact sheets, and advocacy materials, aligned with UNDP communication standards.
- Support with success stories documentation, case studies, and practical impacts of project interventions, translating them into accessible multimedia content (infographics, videos, presentations, social media posts).
- Support the development and maintenance of content for websites, social media pages, donor reports, newsletters, and other communication channels, ensuring wide reach and visibility.
- Ensure all knowledge products are appropriately catalogued and stored in centralized repositories for easy access by project teams, partners, and stakeholders.
- Support with the documentation and reporting of Technical Committee and Steering Committee meetings, including preparation of agendas, compiling supporting materials, taking minutes, and following up on action points.

Monitoring and Evaluation Support

- Support the Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist in collecting, analysing, and documenting project progress to facilitate evidence-based decision-making.
- Support with the maintenance and updating the database of project information, ensuring timely access for teams and partners.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

- Advanced university degree in Communications, Knowledge Management, Information and Data Science, Political Science, International Development, Public Policy, Journalism, Digital Media, or a related field.
- Additional training or certification in digital communication, artificial intelligence applications, or data analytics will be an asset.

Work experience

- At least one year of relevant professional experience, preferably in communications, knowledge management, governance, or development-related contexts.
- Experience (including internships or academic projects) in digital content creation, information management, research, or data visualization will be considered an advantage.
- Familiarity with elections, democratic governance, gender equality, or civic engagement programmes is desirable.

Languages

- Fluency in English (written and spoken) is required.

Other skills

- Proficiency in Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) and content management systems (CMS).
- Familiarity with digital communication tools, including social media management platforms (e.g., X/Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram).
- Familiarity with AI-assisted tools for knowledge management, content generation, and analytics (e.g., Power BI, Canva, Tableau).
- Basic understanding of data visualization, infographics design, and multimedia editing software (e.g., Adobe Creative Suite, Canva, or CapCut).
- Excellent skills in writing, editing, and packaging information for diverse audiences.

Competencies

1. Professionalism

- Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of knowledge management, communication, and digital content development.
- Shows persistence when faced with challenges, remains calm under pressure, and takes responsibility for achieving high-quality results.
- Keeps abreast of emerging trends in digital communication, AI, and information management to enhance programme visibility and learning.

2. Communication

- Speaks and writes clearly and effectively; listens to others, interprets messages correctly, and responds appropriately.
- Adapts communication style to different audiences, using digital and visual storytelling to convey complex concepts in accessible ways.
- Demonstrates proficiency in drafting reports, briefs, and multimedia content that meet UNDP standards and enhance stakeholder engagement.

3. Teamwork

- Works collaboratively with colleagues across diverse backgrounds and disciplines to achieve shared goals.
- Values others' ideas and expertise; is willing to learn from others and share information openly.

- Supports team decisions and contributes to a positive, inclusive, and results-oriented working environment.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment, the Fellow will have acquired practical skills, knowledge, and competencies in the following areas:

- **Knowledge Management and Communication:** Ability to contribute to the design and implement knowledge-sharing systems and develop high-quality communication materials tailored to various audiences.
- **Digital Content Development:** Skills in producing knowledge products such as briefs, infographics, videos, and social media content aligned with UNDP standards.
- **Programme Documentation:** Experience in compiling and maintaining project documentation, minutes, reports, and databases that contribute to institutional memory.
- **Stakeholder Coordination:** Capacity to engage and collaborate with multiple stakeholders including government institutions, civil society, and media actors in democratic governance.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation Support:** Basic understanding of M & E tools and frameworks used in evidence-based reporting and project learning.
- **AI and Data Utilization:** Exposure to emerging technologies, including the application of AI-assisted tools for communication, knowledge capture, and data visualization.
- **Report Writing and Analytical Thinking:** Ability to synthesize field information into clear and concise reports, policy briefs, and knowledge products.
- **Professional and Personal Growth:** Improved teamwork, adaptability, intercultural communication, and project planning skills within a diverse professional environment.

7. Content and methodology of supervision

The Fellow will work under the direct supervision of the Project Manager for the Deepening Democracy Project and in close collaboration with the Country Office's Communications team.

The supervision approach will include:

- **Initial Orientation:** A detailed briefing on UNDP's mandate, office structure, and project objectives, followed by an introduction to key partners and stakeholders.
- **Work Plan Development:** The Fellow, in consultation with the supervisor, will develop a detailed work plan outlining specific task, expected outputs, and learning goals for the assignment period.
- **Regular Check-ins:** Weekly meetings with the supervisor to review progress, discuss challenges, and plan subsequent tasks, and participation in the weekly planning meetings of the DDP.
- **Performance Feedback:** Mid-term and end-of-assignment performance reviews to assess achievements, learning progress, and areas for further professional growth.
- **Collaborative Learning Environment:** Opportunities to participate in Governance and Gender Unit team meetings, joint planning sessions, field missions, and technical discussions to enhance on-the-job learning.

8. Living conditions in the country

The assignment will take place in Lusaka, Zambia. Zambia is known for its political stability, cultural diversity, and friendly population. English is the official language, and local languages are widely spoken. The climate is generally mild with distinct rainy (November–April) and dry (May–October) seasons.

Lusaka is a rapidly developing urban centre with a range of accommodation options, reliable transportation, and access to healthcare, Internet, and essential services. The basic infrastructure is of reasonable standard, although the city experiences power outages from time to time. Medical facilities are still largely inadequate, although several private clinics and hospitals provide reasonably good routine care. Several restaurants around the city serve local or international cuisine and there are numerous social and sports facilities (fitness, tennis, swimming, riding, golf, etc.) in the major hotels or in different

establishments around the city. There are no major or special security concerns within Lusaka city limits. The cost of living is moderate compared to regional standards.

The Fellow will have access to UNDP facilities, including workspace, IT support, and opportunities to participate in professional and social events organized by the UN Country Team. UNDP promotes a safe and inclusive work environment and provides security briefings to ensure adherence to UNDSS safety protocols.